

Nicole Ward

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Profile

QA/Testing specialist with 3 years+ building and shipping production systems. Deep hands-on experience with Postman, Selenium and Docker, most recently at Ironwood Labs.

Key Achievements

- Wrote the team's testing strategy, separating unit, contract and end-to-end responsibilities.
- Integrated automated checks into the Nginx pipeline, blocking 50 faulty releases.
- Reduced escaped defects by 70% through risk-based test prioritisation.

Relevant Experience

QA Engineer

Ironwood Labs | 2024-08 — 2026-01 | East Douglaschester (Remote)

- Partnered with developers to shift testing left, embedding QA in refinement sessions.
- Automated 40 regression suites with Selenium, cutting the manual test cycle by 12%.
- Built the defect triage process and reporting the engineering leads still use.

Quality Engineer, Oracle

2022-03 — 2024-08 | Carolhaven

- Built a performance harness in Postman simulating 30k concurrent users.
- Mentored 15 manual testers into automation roles.

Qualifications

Master, Data Science

Halloway Institute of Technology | 2019 — 2021

Thesis: "Handling label noise in weakly supervised classification"

Bachelor, Data Science

Fairview Institute of Technology | 2015 — 2018

Skills

- Postman
- Selenium
- Docker
- Java
- Nginx
- Next.js
- Looker

Notable Projects

Technical blog

Writing up Docker experiments and failures, roughly 4k readers a month.

Conference talk

Spoke on Selenium in production at a regional meetup, ~70 attendees.

Recognition

Engineering Excellence Award, 2018